

Olympiad Test Paper — Social Science (Class 7)

Chapter 7: The Gupta Era: An Age of Tireless Creativity

Subject	Social Science (NCERT Class 7)
Chapter	7 — The Gupta Era: An Age of Tireless Creativity
Total Questions	60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)
Maximum Marks	240
Suggested Time	90 minutes

Marking scheme: +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

Instructions: Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct. Watch the classic traps: Chandragupta II (Gupta) is NOT Chandragupta Maurya; the Iron Pillar resists rust because of its phosphorus-rich iron, not because 'iron cannot rust'; Faxian saw mainly the prosperous cities and must be cross-checked; the Guptas governed the north and centre directly while the Pallavas (south) and Kamarupa (northeast) ruled their own lands; and a 'Golden Age' means cultural brilliance, not equality for all. Keep the order of the rulers and their works straight. Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

1. The Gupta dynasty rose to power in northern India after which earlier power had weakened?

- (A) the Mauryas, immediately before them (B) the Kushanas
(C) the Pallavas of the south (D) the Hunas of Central Asia

2. The capital of the Gupta Empire was:

- (A) Kanchipuram (B) Pataliputra (present-day Patna)
(C) Pratihsthana (D) Socotra

3. The Gupta Empire is dated roughly to which span?

- (A) about the 3rd to the 6th century CE (B) the 2nd century BCE to the 3rd century CE
(C) the 6th to the 9th century CE (D) the 1st to the 2nd century CE

4. Even at its height, the Gupta Empire is best described as:

- (A) directly ruling every village across the whole subcontinent, just as the Mauryas had
(B) directly governing mainly the north and centre, relying on land grants and allied kings elsewhere
(C) controlling only the single city of Pataliputra
(D) a loose alliance of kingdoms with no central ruler at all

- 5.** The Iron Pillar of Delhi is famous chiefly because it:
- (A) is made of solid gold
 - (B) was raised by Chandragupta Maurya
 - (C) has resisted rusting for well over a thousand years
 - (D) is the tallest tower in India
- 6.** The Iron Pillar resists rust because:
- (A) iron simply cannot rust under any conditions
 - (B) it is coated with fresh gold paint every year
 - (C) its phosphorus-rich iron forms a thin protective layer that seals out oxygen and water
 - (D) it stands in a place where rain never falls
- 7.** The 'Chandra' inscription on the Iron Pillar is generally linked to which ruler?
- (A) Chandragupta II
 - (B) Chandragupta Maurya
 - (C) Samudragupta
 - (D) Kanishka
- 8.** Why must we NOT say 'Chandragupta II is just another name for Chandragupta Maurya'?
- (A) they are the same person with two spellings
 - (B) Chandragupta II actually ruled before the Mauryas
 - (C) neither of them really existed
 - (D) they are different rulers from different dynasties, centuries apart
- 9.** The ruler who first raised the Guptas to imperial status was:
- (A) Samudragupta
 - (B) Chandragupta II
 - (C) Kumaragupta
 - (D) Chandragupta I
- 10.** Chandragupta I strengthened the Guptas by marrying a Licchavi princess. This is an example of:
- (A) a purely religious ceremony with no political aim
 - (B) a matrimonial alliance that boosted the dynasty's power and prestige
 - (C) a way of collecting yearly taxes
 - (D) an attempt to launch a new calendar era
- 11.** The grand title 'Maharajadhiraja' adopted by Gupta rulers means:
- (A) 'servant of the common people'
 - (B) 'great king of kings', claiming supreme authority
 - (C) 'chief priest of the temple'
 - (D) 'commander of the navy'
- 12.** Gupta kings issued finely made gold coins partly to:
- (A) remove the need for any army
 - (B) record the Sangam poems of the Tamil south
 - (C) pay yearly tribute to Rome
 - (D) display their power, achievements and legitimacy

- 13.** Samudragupta is remembered above all as a:
(A) pacifist who never once went to war
(B) warrior king who greatly expanded the empire by conquest
(C) foreign invader from Central Asia (D) Chinese pilgrim who toured India
- 14.** The achievements of Samudragupta are recorded in the:
(A) Aryabhatiya (B) Meghadutam
(C) Brihat Samhita (D) Prayaga Prashasti
- 15.** The Prayaga Prashasti was composed by Samudragupta's court poet:
(A) Kalidasa (B) Aryabhata
(C) Varahamihira (D) Harisena
- 16.** A 'prashasti' is:
(A) a tax-free village granted to brahmins
(B) a formal inscription composed in praise of a king, recording his achievements
(C) a horse-sacrifice ritual (D) a Buddhist monastery
- 17.** Because the Prayaga Prashasti was written by the king's own court poet, a careful historian should:
(A) accept every word as plain, unbiased fact
(B) treat its praise cautiously and cross-check it with other sources
(C) reject it as completely worthless (D) assume it was secretly written by an enemy
- 18.** The Gupta ruler under whom art, literature and science most flourished, titled 'Vikramaditya', was:
(A) Samudragupta (B) Chandragupta I
(C) Chandragupta II (D) Kumaragupta
- 19.** The title 'Vikramaditya' (vikrama + aditya) means:
(A) 'King of Kings' (B) 'Servant of the Gods'
(C) 'Sun of Valour' (D) 'Lord of the Sea'
- 20.** The flourishing of poets, scientists and artists at Chandragupta II's court shows that he acted as a:
(A) regent ruling on behalf of a child (B) foreign conqueror from the northwest
(C) wandering pilgrim (D) patron - a supporter of artists and scholars
- 21.** Which set of achievements is correctly tied to Chandragupta II's reign?
(A) the golden flowering of Kalidasa's poetry and the 'Chandra' Iron Pillar
(B) the Prayaga Prashasti and a conquest-heavy warrior reign
(C) the very first founding of the Gupta empire
(D) the Huna invasions that ended the dynasty
- 22.** Prabhavati Gupta is remembered as a 'diplomat queen' because she:

- (A) personally led the Gupta armies in every battle
- (B) wrote the Aryabhatiya on mathematics
- (C) invented the rust-resistant iron of the pillar
- (D) was a Gupta princess who, after her husband's death, governed as regent and kept strong ties between kingdoms

23. A 'regent' is someone who:

- (A) travels to holy places
- (B) governs a kingdom temporarily on behalf of a monarch unable to rule, often a child
- (C) composes praise-poems for kings
- (D) studies the stars and planets

24. Prabhavati Gupta's career, like that of earlier queens, shows that royal women in ancient India:

- (A) could at times wield real political power
- (B) were never allowed anywhere near governance
- (C) only ever worked as farmers
- (D) were forbidden from marrying into other dynasties

25. Gupta land grants were typically recorded on:

- (A) palm-leaf newspapers
- (B) printed paper deeds
- (C) copper plates
- (D) clay coins

26. An 'agrahara' was:

- (A) a grand royal title
- (B) a horse-sacrifice ritual
- (C) a village or piece of land granted by a king, often tax-free, to brahmins or temples
- (D) a system of gold coinage

27. The title 'Chakravartin' claimed by a ruler meant he was a:

- (A) temple priest
- (B) village headman
- (C) universal or supreme ruler over all lesser kings
- (D) foreign ambassador

28. Granting tax-free land to brahmins and temples could, over time, weaken a king because it:

- (A) forced the king to fight far more wars
- (B) made the king's coins stop working
- (C) ended all trade with Rome
- (D) reduced the taxes flowing into the royal treasury

29. The grand titles and elaborate administration of the Guptas were meant mainly to:

- (A) project the emperor's supreme authority and organise the realm
- (B) hide the fact that the Guptas had no army
- (C) prove the Guptas were foreigners
- (D) remove any need for officials

30. Compared with the Mauryan model of ruling every region directly, the Gupta system relied more on:

- (A) a single elected national council (B) complete withdrawal from all governance
- (C) foreign Roman administrators (D) land grants and allied or subordinate kings

31. Gupta-age trade is described as reaching across the:

- (A) Pacific Ocean to the Americas (B) frozen Arctic seas
- (C) Atlantic, but only as far as Britain (D) Indian Ocean, as far as Socotra and beyond

32. Indian traders' graffiti found in a cave on the faraway island of Socotra is taken as evidence that:

- (A) the Guptas had conquered and ruled Socotra
- (B) Socotrans had invaded India (C) the island was the Gupta capital
- (D) Indian merchants travelled and traded far across the Indian Ocean

33. Why is physical evidence like coins, copper plates and overseas graffiti so important for studying the Gupta age?

- (A) it proves the Guptas kept no written records at all
- (B) it gives historians concrete proof of rulers, land grants and long-distance trade
- (C) it shows the Guptas never traded with anyone
- (D) it removes the need to read any inscriptions

34. Faxian, whose account describes Gupta society, was a:

- (A) Chinese Buddhist pilgrim who travelled across India
- (B) Gupta court poet (C) Roman trader
- (D) Huna general

35. A 'pilgrim' is best defined as:

- (A) a person who governs for a child-king (B) a poet who praises kings
- (C) a person who travels to holy places (D) a maker of coins

36. Faxian paints Gupta cities as prosperous and charitable, yet he also recorded:

- (A) the harsh treatment of the 'untouchable' chandalas, who had to live outside the towns
- (B) that everyone in society was perfectly equal (C) that the Guptas had banned all trade
- (D) that there were no cities at all

37. Faxian's record warns historians that a single eyewitness account:

- (A) is always a complete and perfectly neutral record
- (B) must be ignored entirely
- (C) shows only part of the picture and should be checked against other sources
- (D) was actually written long after the Gupta age

38. The Gupta age is called India's 'Classical Age' mainly because of its:

- (A) complete social equality for every person
- (B) high achievements in art, science and literature, later looked back on as a model
- (C) total absence of any warfare
- (D) rejection of all earlier learning

39. Aryabhata is best described as a:

- (A) warrior king
- (B) court painter
- (C) mathematician and astronomer
- (D) Buddhist pilgrim

40. The 'Aryabhatiya' is:

- (A) a short Sanskrit treatise on mathematics and astronomy, written around 500 CE
- (B) a praise-inscription of Samudragupta
- (C) a Kalidasa play about love
- (D) a Buddhist monastery near Pataliputra

41. India's gift of 'shunya' (zero) and the place-value system mattered to the whole world because it:

- (A) made writing and calculating with large numbers far easier, and later spread across the world
- (B) was used only once and then forgotten
- (C) applied only to temple architecture
- (D) replaced the need for every other number

42. 'Astronomy', the science Aryabhata advanced, is:

- (A) the scientific study of the stars, planets and sky
- (B) the study of traditional medicine
- (C) the art of carving sculptures
- (D) the writing of praise-poems

43. Varahamihira is remembered for his encyclopedic work, the:

- (A) Prayaga Prashasti
- (B) Brihat Samhita
- (C) Meghadutam
- (D) Aryabhatiya

44. Kalidasa, a gem of the Gupta court, was a:

- (A) an astronomer who measured the planets
- (B) an ironsmith who built the pillar
- (C) poet and playwright, author of works such as the Meghadutam
- (D) a Chinese pilgrim

45. That Kalidasa's plays are still performed about 1,500 years later best illustrates:

- (A) that nothing from the Gupta age survived
- (B) that the plays were really written in modern times
- (C) that Gupta literature was only ever about science
- (D) the lasting legacy of Gupta-age literature

46. 'Ayurveda', codified in this age, literally means the:

- (A) 'sun of valour'
- (B) 'great king of kings'
- (C) 'science of life' (ayus + veda)
- (D) 'science of the stars'

47. To 'codify' a body of knowledge such as Ayurveda means to:

- (A) destroy and forget it
- (B) arrange and write it down in an organised, systematic way
- (C) keep it a strict secret forever
- (D) translate it into Greek

48. The cave paintings of Ajanta and the carvings of Sarnath and Udayagiri are examples of Gupta-age:

- (A) scientific instruments
- (B) trade goods exported to Rome
- (C) royal land-grant documents
- (D) artistic achievement

49. Garuda, shown as a royal emblem and the vahana of Vishnu on Gupta symbols, reflects that the Guptas:

- (A) worshipped only foreign Greek gods
- (B) rejected all religion
- (C) drew on Hindu religious imagery to express their authority
- (D) ruled as a Buddhist-only dynasty

50. The Gupta Empire declined in the 6th century CE largely due to:

- (A) a Roman conquest
- (B) a Pallava conquest of the north
- (C) the assassination of Chandragupta Maurya
- (D) invasions by the Hunas

51. The Hunas who pressed on the Guptas came from:

- (A) Central Asia, entering through the northwest
- (B) the Tamil far south
- (C) the islands of the Indian Ocean
- (D) the Brahmaputra valley

52. The pattern of foreign groups entering India 'through the northwest' across many centuries suggests that region was:

- (A) a recurring gateway for invaders and migrants into the subcontinent
- (B) completely sealed off by mountains
- (C) the empire's single richest farmland
- (D) India's main seaport

53. While the Guptas ruled the north, the south was home to the:

- (A) Shungas of central India
- (B) Kushanas of the northwest
- (C) Pallavas of Kanchipuram
- (D) Chedis of Kalinga

54. The Pallava kingdom had its capital at:

- (A) Pataliputra
- (B) Ujjain
- (C) Kanchipuram
- (D) Pratishthana

55. The Kamarupa kingdom of this era lay in the:

- (A) Brahmaputra valley of the northeast
- (B) Kaveri delta of the south
- (C) Indus valley of the northwest
- (D) central Deccan plateau

56. That the Pallavas and Kamarupa flourished alongside the Guptas shows that Gupta India was:

- (A) the only kingdom anywhere in India
- (B) a north-centred empire sharing the subcontinent with other regional kingdoms
- (C) ruled entirely from China
- (D) a province of the Roman Empire

57. To call the Gupta age a 'Golden Age' is accurate mainly about its:

- (A) perfect equality and happiness for every person
- (B) achievements in art, science, literature and trade, not social equality
- (C) complete freedom from any conflict
- (D) total isolation from the outside world

58. Which sequence of Gupta rulers is in correct order (earliest first)?

- (A) Chandragupta I, then Samudragupta, then Chandragupta II
- (B) Chandragupta II, then Samudragupta, then Chandragupta I
- (C) Samudragupta, then Chandragupta I, then Chandragupta II
- (D) Chandragupta II, then Chandragupta I, then Samudragupta

59. Which pairing of ruler and achievement is correct?

- (A) Samudragupta - celebrated in the Prayaga Prashasti
- (B) Chandragupta I - the rust-resistant Iron Pillar
- (C) Chandragupta II - the first Gupta to take an imperial title
- (D) Kanishka - a great Gupta emperor

60. A student claims, 'The Gupta period proves science and art can flourish even while an empire is not perfectly fair.' The best support is:

- (A) every Gupta subject was treated equally and richly
- (B) the Guptas produced no science or art at all
- (C) the Guptas ruled with no titles or administration
- (D) dazzling work by Aryabhata and Kalidasa coexisted with the harsh exclusion of the chandalas

Solutions — Social Science (Class 7), Chapter 7: The Gupta Era: An Age of Tireless Creativity

Marking: +4 correct, –1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	B	11	B	21	A	31	D	41	A	51	A
2	B	12	D	22	D	32	D	42	A	52	A
3	A	13	B	23	B	33	B	43	B	53	C
4	B	14	D	24	A	34	A	44	C	54	C
5	C	15	D	25	C	35	C	45	D	55	A
6	C	16	B	26	C	36	A	46	C	56	B
7	A	17	B	27	C	37	C	47	B	57	B
8	D	18	C	28	D	38	B	48	D	58	A
9	D	19	C	29	A	39	C	49	C	59	A
10	B	20	D	30	D	40	A	50	D	60	D

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

Worked Solutions

1. (B) The Guptas rose around the 3rd century CE after the Kushana Empire weakened. The Mauryas had fallen centuries earlier, the Pallavas were a contemporary southern kingdom, and the Hunas came later and helped end the Guptas.

2. (B) The Guptas ruled from Pataliputra (modern Patna). Kanchipuram was the Pallava capital, Pratishthana a Satavahana centre, and Socotra a distant trading island.

3. (A) The Guptas ruled c. 3rd-6th century CE. The 2nd-c-BCE-to-3rd-c-CE span is the Age of Reorganisation, the 6th-9th centuries are later, and the 1st-2nd centuries CE were Kushana times.

4. (B) The Guptas governed the north and centre directly, while the south (Pallavas) and northeast (Kamarupa) had their own kingdoms and the Guptas leaned on land grants and allies. They neither ruled all India village-by-village, nor were they a single city or a ruler-less alliance.

5. (C) The Iron Pillar is renowned for resisting rust across centuries. It is iron (not gold), linked to the Gupta 'Chandra' inscription (not the Maurya founder), and famed for rust-

resistance rather than height.

6. (C) A special phosphorus-rich iron lets a thin protective film form, shielding the metal from oxygen and moisture. Iron normally rusts easily; there is no gold paint, and the dry-climate idea is not the chapter's explanation.

7. (A) The pillar's 'Chandra' is linked to the Gupta Chandragupta II ('Vikramaditya'), not the much earlier Maurya founder, nor Samudragupta, nor the Kushana Kanishka.

8. (D) Chandragupta Maurya founded the Maurya Empire centuries earlier; Chandragupta II was a later Gupta ruler. They share a name but are distinct people from different dynasties.

9. (D) Chandragupta I lifted the Guptas to an imperial power and took the grand title Maharajadhiraja. Samudragupta and Chandragupta II were his successors, and Kumaragupta a later ruler.

10. (B) The Licchavi marriage was a political alliance that raised Gupta prestige - diplomacy through marriage, not a mere religious rite, a tax device, or a calendar launch.

11. (B) Maharajadhiraja means 'great king of kings', asserting paramount power over lesser kings. It is not a humble servant title, a priestly office, or a naval rank.

12. (D) Gupta gold coinage advertised royal power, victories and legitimacy (and aided trade). Coins did not replace armies, carry Tamil poetry, or signal tribute to Rome.

13. (B) Samudragupta was the conquering 'warrior king' who enlarged the empire. He was not a pacifist, a foreign invader, or the pilgrim Faxian.

14. (D) The Prayaga Prashasti (the Allahabad pillar inscription) praises Samudragupta. The Aryabhatiya is Aryabhata's science treatise, the Meghadutam is Kalidasa's poem, and the Brihat Samhita is Varahamihira's encyclopedia.

15. (D) Harisena, Samudragupta's court poet, composed the Prayaga Prashasti. Kalidasa served at Chandragupta II's court, Aryabhata was a mathematician, and Varahamihira an astronomer-scholar.

16. (B) A prashasti is a praise-inscription of a ruler's deeds. The tax-free village is an agrahara, the ritual is the ashvamedha, and the monastery is a vihara.

17. (B) A court poet's praise of his patron is likely flattering, so its claims should be weighed against other evidence - neither swallowed whole nor dismissed entirely, and not assumed hostile.

18. (C) Chandragupta II 'Vikramaditya' presided over the golden flowering of art and learning. Samudragupta was the warrior king, Chandragupta I the founder, and

Kumaragupta a later ruler.

19. (C) From vikrama ('valour') + aditya ('sun'), Vikramaditya means 'Sun of Valour'. 'King of kings' is Maharajadhiraja; the others are invented titles.

20. (D) By supporting artists and scholars, Chandragupta II was their patron. A regent governs for another (which he was not), nor was he a foreign conqueror or a pilgrim.

21. (A) Chandragupta II's reign is linked to Kalidasa and the Iron Pillar's Chandra inscription. The conquest reign and Prayaga Prashasti belong to Samudragupta, the founding to Chandragupta I, and the Huna invasions to the later decline.

22. (D) Prabhavati Gupta, a Gupta princess married into another dynasty, ruled as regent for her sons and maintained alliances - diplomacy in action. She was not an army commander, the author of the Aryabhatiya, or a metallurgist.

23. (B) A regent rules in place of a monarch who cannot (often a minor). The traveller is a pilgrim, the praise-poet writes a prashasti, and the star-student is an astronomer.

24. (A) A queen ruling as regent and steering alliances shows royal women could hold genuine power. They were not barred from governance, confined to farming, or forbidden cross-dynasty marriage, which was itself a key alliance tool.

25. (C) Gupta land grants (agraharas) were inscribed on durable copper plates. Palm-leaf 'newspapers', printed paper and clay coins are anachronistic or invented.

26. (C) An agrahara was a (usually tax-free) land grant to brahmins or temples. The grand title is Maharajadhiraja, the ritual the ashvamedha, and coinage a separate matter.

27. (C) Chakravartin denotes a universal ruler claiming dominion over all lesser kings. It is not a priest, a village head, or an ambassador.

28. (D) Each tax-free grant meant less revenue for the crown, which could weaken central finances over time - a subtle administrative cost. It did not compel wars, disable coins, or halt trade.

29. (A) Lofty titles and a layered administration advertised supreme authority and helped run the realm. They did not mask a missing army, mark the Guptas as foreign, or remove the need for officials.

30. (D) The Guptas governed the core directly but leaned on land grants and allied or subordinate kings elsewhere, unlike the more centralised Mauryan model. There was no elected council, no withdrawal from governance, and no Roman administration.

31. (D) Gupta trade crossed the Indian Ocean, reaching Socotra and beyond. It did not reach the Americas, the Arctic, or Britain across the Atlantic.

- 32. (D)** Such graffiti shows Indian merchants ranged far across the Indian Ocean in trade - not conquest of Socotra, an invasion of India, or the island being a capital.
- 33. (B)** Coins, copper-plate grants and traders' graffiti are concrete sources for Gupta rulers, administration and far-flung trade. They do not show an absence of records or of trade, and they ARE inscriptions to be read, not a substitute for them.
- 34. (A)** Faxian was a Chinese Buddhist pilgrim who toured India and recorded what he saw. He was not a Gupta court poet, a Roman trader, or a Huna general.
- 35. (C)** A pilgrim travels to sacred sites. The child-king's stand-in is a regent, the praise-poet writes a prashasti, and coins are made by mint-workers.
- 36. (A)** Faxian noted both prosperity AND the harsh exclusion of the chandalas, who lived outside towns - so society was not equal. He did not report banned trade or an absence of cities.
- 37. (C)** Faxian saw mainly prosperous cities from his own viewpoint, so his account is partial and must be cross-checked - neither perfectly complete and neutral, nor worthless, nor a late forgery.
- 38. (B)** 'Classical Age' (from Latin classicus, 'of the highest class') refers to its peak achievements in art, science and literature. It does not claim social equality, an absence of war, or a break with earlier learning.
- 39. (C)** Aryabhata was a mathematician and astronomer, author of the Aryabhatiya. He was not a king, a painter, or a pilgrim.
- 40. (A)** The Aryabhatiya (c. 500 CE) is Aryabhata's compact treatise on mathematics and astronomy. The praise-inscription is the Prayaga Prashasti, Kalidasa wrote literature, and a monastery is a vihara.
- 41. (A)** The place-value system with zero (shunya) hugely simplified calculation and spread worldwide. It was not a one-off, was not limited to architecture, and works alongside the other digits rather than replacing them.
- 42. (A)** Astronomy (Greek astron 'star' + nomos 'law') studies the stars, planets and sky. Traditional medicine is Ayurveda, carving is sculpture, and praise-poetry is the prashasti tradition.
- 43. (B)** Varahamihira wrote the wide-ranging Brihat Samhita. The Prayaga Prashasti praises Samudragupta, the Meghadutam is Kalidasa's poem, and the Aryabhatiya is Aryabhata's.
- 44. (C)** Kalidasa was the celebrated poet-playwright of the Meghadutam and other works. The planet-measurer is Aryabhata or Varahamihira, the ironsmith is anonymous, and the

pilgrim is Faxian.

45. (D) Kalidasa's enduring popularity shows the lasting legacy of Gupta literature. It is not evidence that nothing survived, that the plays are modern, or that Gupta writing was only scientific.

46. (C) Ayurveda (ayus 'life' + veda 'knowledge') is the 'science of life', India's traditional medicine. 'Sun of valour' is Vikramaditya, 'great king of kings' is Maharajadhiraja, and the star-science is astronomy.

47. (B) To codify is to set knowledge down systematically. It is the opposite of destroying or hiding it, and is not the same as translating it.

48. (D) Ajanta's paintings and the sculptures of Sarnath and Udayagiri are celebrated Gupta art. They are not instruments, export goods, or land-grant deeds.

49. (C) Using Garuda (Vishnu's vahana, or mount) as an emblem shows the Guptas drawing on Hindu imagery for royal authority. They did not worship only Greek gods, reject religion, or rule as a Buddhist-only dynasty.

50. (D) Repeated Huna invasions in the 6th century gravely weakened the Guptas. Rome did not conquer them, the Pallavas were a southern kingdom, and Chandragupta Maurya belonged to a far earlier era.

51. (A) The Hunas were Central Asian invaders entering through the northwest, like earlier waves. They did not come from the Tamil south, the ocean islands, or the northeastern Brahmaputra valley.

52. (A) From the Indo-Greeks to the Hunas, the northwest was repeatedly the entry route - a recurring gateway, not a sealed wall, the chief farmland, or a seaport.

53. (C) The Pallavas, based at Kanchipuram, flourished in the south during the Gupta age. The Shungas, Kushanas and Chedis belonged to earlier periods and other regions.

54. (C) The Pallavas ruled from Kanchipuram. Pataliputra was the Gupta capital, while Ujjain and Pratishthana were other cities.

55. (A) Kamarupa was the northeastern kingdom of the Brahmaputra valley. The Kaveri delta was Chola country, the Indus the northwest, and the Deccan the Satavahana heartland.

56. (B) Strong contemporaries in the south and northeast show the Guptas shared the subcontinent rather than ruling all of it. India was not a single kingdom, China-ruled, or Roman.

57. (B) The 'golden' label fits its cultural and economic peak; society remained unequal, as the exclusion of the chandalas shows. It does not mean universal equality, an absence of conflict, or isolation.

58. (A) The order is Chandragupta I (founder), then his son Samudragupta (warrior king), then Chandragupta II ('Vikramaditya'). The other orderings scramble this.

59. (A) Samudragupta is the one praised in the Prayaga Prashasti. The Iron Pillar links to Chandragupta II (not Chandragupta I), the first imperial title to Chandragupta I (not II), and Kanishka was a Kushana, not a Gupta.

60. (D) Brilliant Gupta science and literature flourished even as the chandalas were harshly excluded - high culture alongside an unequal society. The other options deny either the inequality or the achievements.